THE GENDER PAY GAP

IN THE UNITED STATES

Women earn less than men across all major measures. Here's a look at the gap from 1981 to 2013.

Source: https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/fedesoriano/gender-pay-gap-dataset/data
By Ruonan Wu

OVERALL STATISTICS

Across full-time, year-round workers in the United States, women earn significantly less than men on average.

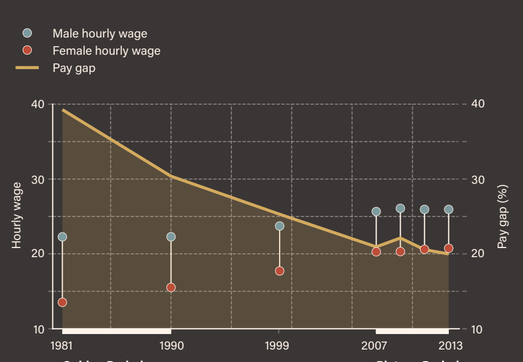
Women earn **$0.76 USD** for every **$1 USD** earned by men.

This represents an overall **24%** gender pay gap.



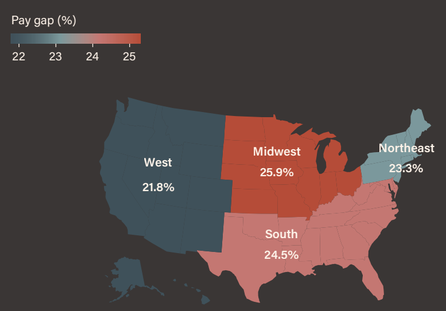
HISTORY'S SLOW HEALING

From 1981 to 2013, the gender pay gap shows a gradual improvement, but inequality remains consistent over time. Women continue to earn less than men in every observed year.



U.S. REGION

Geography changes the size of the gap, but not the basic direction of inequality. The west region perform better than others, but the pay gap remains a repeated national pattern.



How To Read The Occupation Panel

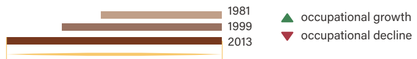
Same occupation order across all three charts
Each row refers to the same occupation, so you can compare distribution, size, and gap directly.

Pay gap definition

Pay Gap (%) = (1 - Male mean hourly wage / Female mean hourly wage)×100

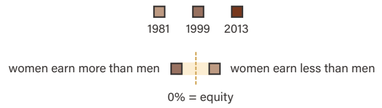
Workforce size

Three horizontal bars per occupation show weighted population (millions) in 1981, 1999, and 2013.



Gender pay gap over time

Each row is a range-style dumbbell for pay gap across 1981, 1999, and 2013.



Wage distribution

Filled curves show the distribution of hourly wages by sex in each occupation (1981 / 1999 / 2013 panels).



The Workforce Shifted Over Time

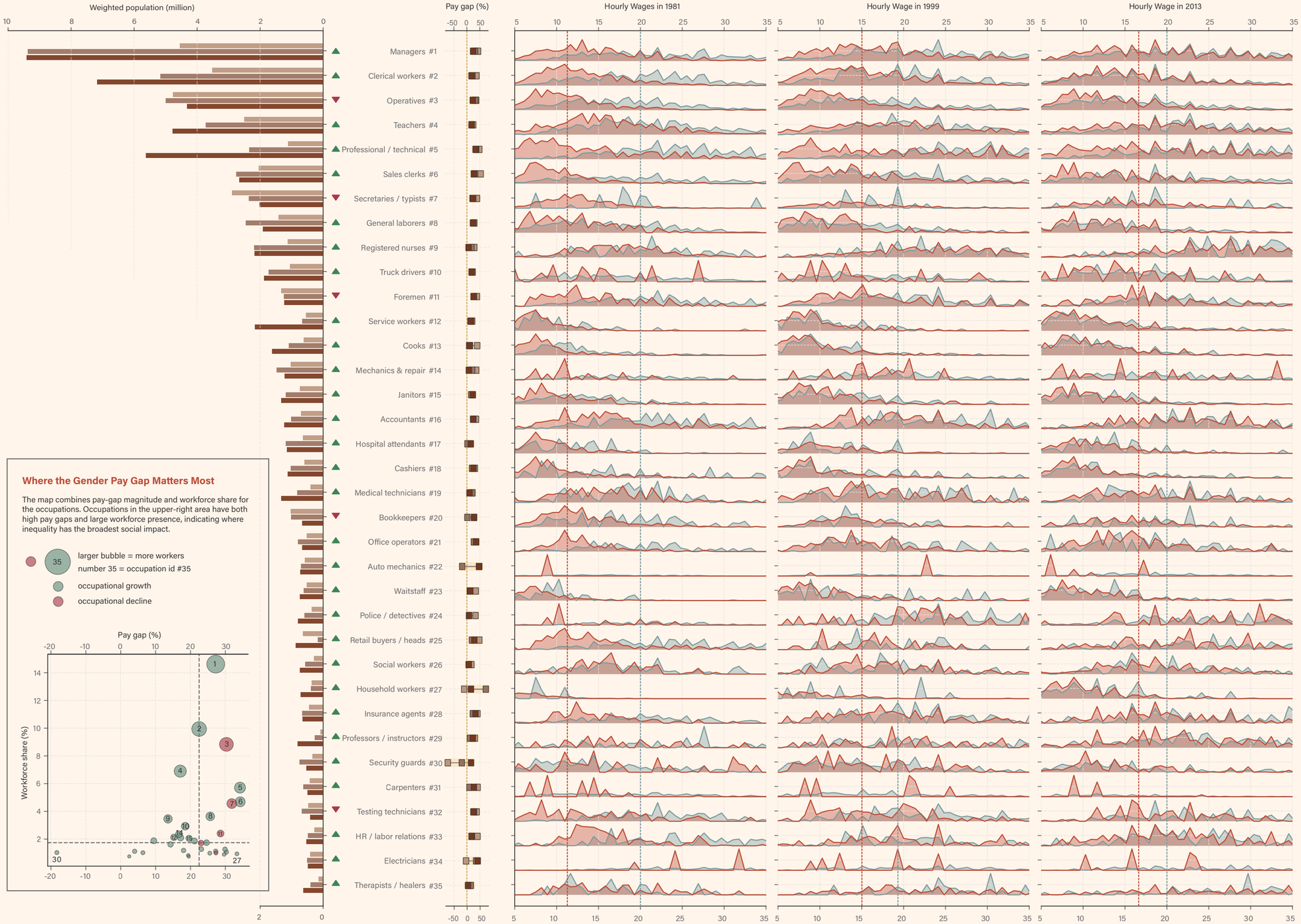
Traditional occupations such as operatives, typists, foremen, and bookkeepers declined between 1981 and 2013, while service, clerical, and professional roles expanded significantly.

Gender Pay Gaps Persist

Men earned more than women in nearly every occupation throughout the period.

Wage Hierarchies Across Occupations

Higher-paying professions consistently remain at the top of the wage distribution, while service and manual occupations cluster at lower income levels. Across most occupations, men continue to earn more than women.



Where the Gender Pay Gap Matters Most

The map combines pay-gap magnitude and workforce share for the occupations. Occupations in the upper-right area have both high pay gaps and large workforce presence, indicating where inequality has the broadest social impact.